



S.AF.E's CMU Peer Recovery & Prevention Initiative

Application details

Mesa County Opioid Crisis Recovery Fund Grant Outline and Criteria

The Colorado Opioid Crisis Recovery Fund is an opportunity for state, regional, and local partnerships to make significant impact against the opioid epidemic that has caused over 5,000 deaths in Colorado over the past 10 years.

Mesa County has identified the following goals and objectives for the next two years of opioid settlement funding:

Goal 1:

Decrease the number of young people in Mesa County interested in, or already using, substances and provide opportunities for youth with developed substance use disorders (SUDs).

Objectives:

- Increase youth mentoring opportunities for young people at risk of SUD.
- Implement a youth diversion program to provide alternative pathways to treatment and recovery for young people with behavioral issues.
- Disseminate a tailored prevention education campaign geared towards young people in Mesa County.

Goal 2:

Increase the number of health care professionals in Mesa County who are educated and qualified to treat people with SUDs.

Objective:

- Fund Certified Addiction Specialist (CAS) trainings for clinical professionals.

Goal 3:

Reduce relapse and recidivism rates among people with SUDs in Mesa County.

Objective:

- Ensure SUD treatment and wrap around services are immediately accessible for individuals reentering the community from incarceration, homelessness, or residential treatment settings.

Goal 4:

Establish a thriving recovery community in Mesa County with the infrastructure, resources, and staff needed to support those seeking recover.

Objectives:

- Develop or expand upon an existing Recovery Community Organization (RCO) to increase visibility of and support for people in recovery in Mesa County.
- Increase peer delivered care coordination of people with SUD in Mesa County.
- Provide peer recover specialist trainings and other peer specific trainings and supervision to advance the peer workforce in Mesa County.

Goal 5:

Evaluate region 13 settlement spending.

Objective:

- Ensure responsible spending of governance committee by evaluating the quality of funded programs annually.

Mesa County will be receiving a total of approximately \$763,000.00 per year. Awards will be divided among several projects.

Funding is split into three service areas:

- Prevention and Education
- Treatment
- Recovery

Please choose one funding area for your request. If your agency/program fits into multiple service areas (ex. treatment *and* recovery), please fill out an additional application for each service area. If your agency has more than one program, please fill out a separate application for each program. Once one application is completed, you may choose to "copy" your application and make the changes necessary to submit the next. This can be done on the home page by clicking the three dots located next to the your first application, then select "copy".

Goal of percent of funding allocated to each service area:

- Prevention and Education: 49%
- Treatment: 7%
- Recovery: 44%

Please note that these funds are strictly to increase the capacity of clients served, not to supplement services to existing clients.

Funding is to be utilized to support programs that build workforce, evidence-based treatments, or prevention and education efforts. Capital requests will be considered on a case-by-case basis

Funding is not to be used for:

- General operating supplies

To clarify, general operating supplies include, but are not limited to:

- Office Supplies: Items such as paper, pens, notepads, staplers, folders, and other general stationery items.
- Cleaning Supplies: Products used for routine cleaning and maintenance, such as disinfectants, brooms, mops, and trash bags.
- Consumables: Materials that are regularly used up and need to be replaced, such as printer ink cartridges, batteries, light bulbs, and other similar items.
- Miscellaneous Supplies: Other items that are not directly tied to the execution of specific projects or programs, including coffee, snacks, water, and other amenities.

- Marketing/promotional materials for the program and swag items

- Participant incentives or awards

Please note that this does not apply to Contingency Management (CM)

Non-opioid SUD prevention and education, treatment, or recovery programs may be eligible as long as the program also serves those with opioid-specific substance use disorders.

Grants are awarded on a two-year cycle. If awarded, year one funding will be released in January 2025. Year two funding will be awarded in January 2026 dependent on achievement of deliverables.

Applications are due by 5:00pm on Monday, August 19, 2024

Application questions should be directed to impact@uwmesacounty.org

I confirm that I meet the eligibility criteria for this grant

✓

Legal name of applying agency

Sober AF Entertainment, INC.

Mailing address line 1

485 2nd Ave

Mailing address line 2

#4204

City

Longmont

State

Colorado

Zip

80501

Agency phone number	+13038889019
Agency website	https://soberafe.com/
Agency EIN	83-0685262
CEO or Executive Director name	Daniel Rumely
Type of agency	Nonprofit Organization
Tax exemption status	501(c)(3)

What is the mission of the applying agency?

Sober AF Entertainment's mission is to create safe and inclusive environments for individuals in recovery and those who choose to live a sober lifestyle. By promoting and hosting sober sections at mainstream events, we aim to reduce the stigma associated with sobriety and offer a supportive community for those seeking connection without the influence of substances. Beyond events, SAFE is dedicated to providing resources and education centered on peer support and harm-reduction initiatives. We empower individuals to celebrate life and enjoy memorable experiences without the need for alcohol or drugs. Our commitment extends to bridging the gap between the sober community and the general public, fostering understanding, acceptance, and a culture of inclusivity.

Describe the applying agency and provide a brief history

Sober AF Entertainment, commonly referred to as SAFE, was founded in 2018 by a group of passionate individuals who recognized a significant gap in the entertainment industry: the lack of sober spaces at mainstream events. Recognizing the challenges faced by those in recovery or choosing a sober lifestyle, SAFE set out to create environments where individuals could enjoy concerts, sports, and other events without the pressures or triggers of alcohol and drugs.

From its inception, SAFE has been more than just an event organizer. We are advocates for a cultural shift, challenging societal norms that often equate fun and relaxation with substance use. Our events, which began as small gatherings, quickly gained traction, leading to partnerships with major event organizers and venues across the country.

Over the years, SAFE has expanded its reach, not only hosting sober sections at events but also providing resources, education, and support around peer-driven sober support and harm-reduction initiatives. Our approach is holistic, understanding that sobriety is not just about abstaining from substances but also about building connections, fostering understanding, and creating a community.

Our history is a testament to the power of community and the human spirit. From humble beginnings, SAFE has grown into a movement, touching the lives of thousands and proving that fun, connection, and memorable experiences are not dependent on substances but on genuine human connection and shared experiences.

List the major programs related to opioid prevention, education, treatment, recovery, harm reduction, and/or criminal justice offered by your agency. Provide a brief description of each program and indicate the program/s for which you are requesting funding.

Sober Sections at Mainstream Events:

SAFE partners with major event organizers and venues to designate sober sections at concerts, sports events, and festivals. These sections provide a substance-free environment, allowing attendees to enjoy the event without the pressures or triggers of alcohol and drugs.

Funding Request: Yes, for expanding the number of events and outreach.

Harm Reduction Workshops:

SAFE organizes workshops aimed at educating the community about harm reduction strategies, safe substance use, and

overdose prevention. These workshops also distribute naloxone kits and provide training on their use.
Funding Request: Yes, for expanding workshop reach and increasing the number of kits distributed.

Peer Mentorship Program:

A mentorship initiative where individuals in long-term recovery mentor those newly entering recovery. This program provides guidance, support, and a sense of community to those navigating the challenges of early recovery.

Funding Request: Yes, for program expansion and training of new mentors.

For this grant application, we are specifically requesting funding for the expansion of our Sober Sections at Mainstream Events, the growth of our Harm Reduction Workshops, and the enhancement of our Peer Mentorship Program. These programs align closely with the goals of opioid prevention, education, and recovery support, making a tangible difference in the lives of those affected by the opioid crisis.

Is this agency currently in a probationary status? No

Please select your agency's governance structure Volunteer Board of Directors

Current Agency Sources of Income

		Total dollar amount	% of agency budget
1	Individual Contributions	US\$4,637.92	4
2	Foundations	0	0
3	Billing/Billing Reimbursement	0	0
4	Program Service Revenue	US\$14,913.65	12
5	Fees/Earned Income	US\$10,000.00	8
6	Govt Grant - Federal	0	0
7	Govt Grant - State	0	0
8	Govt Grant - County/Local	US\$96,500.48	77
9	Govt Contracts	0	0
10	In-Kind Contributions	0	0
11	Other	-US\$800.74	-1

If you completed line 11 in the above table, please provide additional details on "other" income

Agency Balance Sheet

		Beginning of year	End of year
1	Cash (non-interest-bearing)	0	0
2	Savings and temporary cash investments	US\$202,648.38	US\$156,330.66
3	Pledges and grants receivable	US\$17,041.54	US\$22,774.92
4	Other assets	0	0
5	Total assets	US\$219,689.92	US\$179,105.58
6	Accounts payable and accrued expenses	US\$7,168.82	US\$15,314.50
7	Grants payable	0	0
8	Other liabilities	US\$165,700.00	US\$162,075.00
9	Total liabilities	US\$172,868.82	US\$177,389.50
10	Total liabilities and net assets/fund balances	US\$219,689.92	US\$179,105.58

Agency Revenue/Expense Snapshot

		Total dollar amount
1	Total Revenue	US\$125,251.31
2	Total Expense	US\$170,356.33
3	Surplus/Deficit	US\$45,105.02

Program name

S.AF.E's CMU Peer Recovery & Prevention Initiative

Please select the service area for which your program is seeking funding

Prevention and Education

Total amount requested for 2 years	US\$15,400.00
Physical address of program location (street, city, state, zip)	1100 North Ave, Grand Junction, CO 81501
Date of program inception or expected start date	2024-01-01

Please provide a narrative of the program for which you are seeking funding

The college experience is often synonymous with newfound freedoms, exploration, and unfortunately, exposure to substance use. Recognizing the unique challenges and pressures faced by students, Sober AF Entertainment (SAFE) proposes a series of four sober events/tailgates at Colorado Mesa University (CMU) in Mesa County. Drawing from our past successes at football tailgates & student organization led events, these events will not only offer an alternative entertainment option but also serve as a platform for vital prevention and education efforts.

1. Sober Tailgates at CMU Events/Football Games:

To provide a fun, engaging, and substance-free environment for students during events/football games, promoting the idea that enjoyment and sobriety can coexist.

SAFE will organize 2 tailgates at CMU's football games & 2 student led events. These events will feature music, games, and food, ensuring students have a memorable experience without the influence of alcohol or drugs. Our past events have seen enthusiastic participation, and we anticipate even greater turnout with continued efforts.

By offering these substance-free events, we aim to challenge the prevailing norms around college drinking and partying, providing students with a safe and enjoyable alternative.

2. Peer Support and Harm Reduction Workshops:

To educate students about harm reduction, safe substance use, and the benefits of peer support.

At each event/tailgate, SAFE will collaborate with local community partners to facilitate workshops and training sessions. Peer support specialists will share their experiences, offering guidance and support to students. Additionally, harm-reduction resources, including naloxone kits, will be distributed. Training sessions on the use of naloxone and recognizing signs of an overdose will also be conducted.

Through these workshops, students will be equipped with life-saving knowledge and tools. The presence of peer support specialists will also emphasize the importance of community and shared experiences in prevention efforts.

3. Community Collaboration:

To foster a sense of collective responsibility and action against substance misuse, SAFE will partner with local organizations, health professionals, and university departments to ensure the tailgates are holistic in their approach. These collaborations will enhance the quality of resources provided and ensure a wider reach.

By bringing together various stakeholders, we aim to create a unified front against substance misuse, emphasizing the role of community in prevention and support.

The college years are formative, filled with challenges and opportunities. At SAFE, we believe in harnessing these opportunities to create lasting change. Our series of sober events at CMU is not just about providing an alternative entertainment option; it's about reshaping perceptions, equipping students with vital knowledge, and fostering a sense of community and support. With the Prevention and Education funding, we can make these tailgates a beacon of hope, fun, and education, ensuring that the students of CMU are well-equipped to make informed choices about their well-being.

Describe the duration and frequency in which clients are offered services

Each event will last approximately 4-5 hours, each tailgate encompassing the pre-game tailgate, game duration, and a brief post-game period. Workshops and speaker sessions will be conducted prior to kick-off at each tailgate or beginning of each

student led event. Each workshop will last approximately 1-1.5 hours, allowing for comprehensive coverage of topics by speakers while retaining student engagement. Training sessions on the use of naloxone and recognizing signs of an overdose will be conducted during each tailgate event and will last approximately 10-15 minutes.

There will be a total of four events, strategically scheduled to coincide with CMU's home football games & student orientation schedule throughout the school year. This ensures consistent engagement with students and maximizes the program's impact.

Please describe the expected outcome of this program

Outcomes:

1. Increased Awareness and Education:

Students will gain a deeper understanding of the risks associated with substance misuse, particularly opioids, and the benefits of choosing sober recreational activities. Student will get an enhanced knowledge about harm reduction strategies and the importance of peer support in preventing substance misuse.

2. Skill Development:

A significant number of students will be trained in recognizing signs of an opioid overdose and will be equipped with the skills to administer naloxone, potentially saving lives. Students will develop peer support skills, enabling them to assist and guide their peers towards healthier choices.

3. Promotion of Sober Recreation:

By hosting sober events, the program will demonstrate that fun and engaging recreational activities can be enjoyed without the influence of substances, challenging the prevailing norms around college drinking and drug use.

4. Strengthened Community Ties:

Collaborations with local community partners for naloxone training and other harm-reduction initiatives will foster stronger ties between CMU and the Mesa County community, promoting a unified approach to substance misuse prevention.

5. Reduction in Substance Misuse Incidents:

With increased awareness, education, and the availability of sober recreational options, we anticipate a measurable reduction in substance-related incidents during and after CMU events/games.

6. Enhanced Peer Support Network:

The presence of trained peer support specialists at tailgate events will lead to the establishment of a robust peer support network on campus, providing students with accessible resources and guidance.

7. Positive Feedback and Engagement:

Through post-event surveys and feedback mechanisms, we expect to receive positive feedback from students regarding the tailgate events, indicating their appreciation for sober recreational options and the educational components provided.

8. Sustainability and Expansion:

The success of this program will pave the way for its continuation in subsequent years and potential expansion to other sporting or university events, amplifying its impact and reach.

In conclusion, SAFE's program aims to bring about a positive shift in student attitudes towards substance use, empower them with life-saving skills, and foster a culture of sober recreation and peer support. The ripple effects of this program are expected to benefit not just the students but the broader Mesa County community, creating a safer and more informed environment for all.

Document the proven success of your program. Cite sources to support your success.

CMU International Overdose Awareness Day Tribute @ Colorado Mesa University (Grand Junction - Colorado) [Tue 08/31/21]

Total Live Reach: 45
Total Training Attendees: 40
Total Orgs Communicated With: 20
Total Naloxone Trainings: 1
Total Naloxone Kits Distributed: 15

Spring Into Sobriety Meeting @ Ballroom at Colorado Mesa University (Grand Junction - Colorado) [Sat 03/12/22]

Total Live Reach: 150
Total Training Attendees: 100
Total Orgs Communicated With: 10

Movie Night w/ CMU Psychology Club & MCORG @ University Center Ballroom at Colorado Mesa University (Grand Junction - Colorado) [Wed 09/28/22]

Total Live Reach: 110
Total Training Attendees: 25
Total Peer Specialist Opportunities: 5
Total Peer Training Hours: 15
Total Peer Interactions: 40
Total Peer Referrals: 4
Total Peer Interest Generated: 1
Total Orgs Communicated With: 10

Educational Panel with MCORG & CMU Psychology Club @ University Center Ballroom at Colorado Mesa University (Grand Junction - Colorado) [Thu 09/29/22]

Total Live Reach: 80
Total Training Attendees: 70
Total Peer Specialist Opportunities: 3
Total Peer Training Hours: 3
Total Peer Interactions: 5
Total Peer Referrals: 3
Total Peer Interest Generated: 0
Total Orgs Communicated With: 15

Mental Health Appreciation Day Event with CMU Psychology Club @ University Center Ballroom at Colorado Mesa University (Grand Junction - Colorado) [Wed 04/12/23]

Total Live Reach: 22
Total Training Attendees: 22
Total Peer Specialist Opportunities: 1
Total Peer Training Hours: 1
Total Peer Interactions: 4
Total Peer Referrals: 3
Total Peer Interest Generated: 1
Total Orgs Communicated With: 3

Upcoming:

Maverick Mania @ University Center Ballroom at Colorado Mesa University (Grand Junction - Colorado) [Sat 08/19/23]

Describe the program's strategy of being socially connected. Ex: Task forces, coalitions, strategic partnerships, etc.

List the organizations and agencies that you currently collaborate with or would like to collaborate with to reach the expected outcome.

1. Task Forces:

- SAFE Student Task Force: A dedicated group of student volunteers from CMU will be formed to act as ambassadors for the program. They will engage with their peers, gather feedback, and provide insights to tailor the program to the evolving needs of the student body.

2. Coalitions:

- Mesa County Substance Prevention Coalition: Collaborating with this local coalition will allow us to tap into a network of professionals and organizations dedicated to substance misuse prevention, enhancing the impact and reach of our program.

3. Strategic Partnerships:

- Colorado Mesa University Health Services: Partnering with the university's health services will provide students with direct access to medical professionals, counseling, and resources related to substance misuse and mental health.
- Local Law Enforcement: Collaborating with local police and campus security ensures a safe environment during tailgate events and facilitates educational sessions on the legal implications of substance misuse.

4. Community Organizations and Agencies:

- Mesa County Public Health: Their expertise in public health campaigns and access to resources will be invaluable in shaping the educational components of our program.
- Local Recovery Centers: Centers such as the Western Colorado Area Health Education Center can provide speakers, resources, and support for students seeking help or information about recovery.

5. Potential Collaborations:

- Mesa County School District: By collaborating with local schools, we can extend our educational outreach to younger students, laying the foundation for informed choices as they transition to higher education.
- Local Businesses and Sponsors: Engaging with businesses in Mesa County can provide sponsorship opportunities, in-kind donations, and promotional support for our events.
- Student Organizations: Collaborating with fraternities, sororities, and other student groups can amplify our message and expand our reach within the CMU community.

State specifically how your program meets the identified service area you have chosen for your funding request

1. Substance Misuse Prevention:

- Peer-Led Initiatives: By hosting sober events, we provide students with a fun, engaging, and substance-free environment. These events serve as a testament that enjoyment and socialization can occur without the need for substances.
- Naloxone Distribution and Training: In collaboration with local partners, we offer naloxone kits and training sessions at our events. This proactive approach not only equips students to respond to opioid overdoses but also educates them on the dangers of opioid misuse.

2. Educational Outreach:

- Information Booths: At each tailgate, we set up booths that provide educational materials on substance misuse, its consequences, and available resources for help.
- Guest Speakers: We invite professionals, recovery advocates, and individuals with lived experiences to share their stories and insights, offering a real-world perspective on the dangers of substance misuse and the power of recovery.

3. Community Engagement and Awareness:

- Collaborative Workshops: In partnership with local organizations, we conduct workshops that delve into topics like responsible behavior, the science of addiction, and harm-reduction strategies.

- Awareness Campaigns: Leveraging the power of social media and campus networks, we run campaigns leading up to our events, highlighting facts, debunking myths, and promoting healthy choices.

4. Building Resilience and Peer Support:

- Peer Support Specialists: At our events, trained peer support specialists are available to engage with students, offering guidance, sharing their own recovery journeys, and directing those in need to appropriate resources.
- Safe Spaces: Our community act as safe havens where students can freely discuss their challenges, seek advice, or simply enjoy a supportive community without judgment or pressure.

Feedback and Continuous Improvement:

- Post-Event Surveys: After each event, we distribute surveys to gather feedback on our initiatives, gauge the effectiveness of our educational components, and identify areas for improvement. This ensures that our program remains responsive to the evolving needs of the CMU community.

By combining engaging events with educational components, peer support, and community collaboration, we address the multifaceted challenges of substance misuse head-on, fostering a healthier and more informed student body at CMU.

Total annual cost of program US\$7,700.00
(including administration, staff
salaries, and services)

Current Program Sources of Income

		Total dollar amount	% of program budget
1	Individual Contributions	0	0
2	Foundations	0	0
3	Business	0	0
4	Program Service Revenue	US\$7,700.00	100
5	Fees/Earned Income	0	0
6	Govt Grant - Federal	0	0
7	Govt Grant - State	0	0
8	Govt Grant - County/Local	0	0
9	Govt Contracts	0	0
10	In-Kind Contributions	0	0
11	Other	0	0

Current Program Revenue/Expense Snapshot

		Total dollar amount
1	Total Revenue	US\$2,500.00
2	Total Expense	US\$7,700.00
3	Surplus/Deficit	-US\$5,200.00

Discuss any major changes in program revenue or expense anticipated for the period covered by this grant

NA

If awarded, please describe how you will use funding in year one

Program Director: LOE 4% of \$80,000 Salary = \$3,200
Tickets For Community Groups: 20 Tickets 2 Tailgates = 40 Tickets \$30 (AVG Ticket Cost) = \$1,200
Naloxone Kit Have 200 free cases = \$0
Food Per Person: \$3 per Person AVG * 200 Total Attendees = \$600
Event Booth & Setup Costs: \$500 per Event X 4 Events = \$2,000
Indirect Costs: 10% of \$7,000 = \$700

YEAR 1 TOTAL COST: \$7,700

If awarded, please describe how you will use funding in year two

Program Director: LOE 4% of \$80,000 Salary = \$3,200
Tickets For Community Groups: 20 Tickets 2 Tailgates = 40 Tickets \$30 (AVG Ticket Cost) = \$1,200
Naloxone Kit Have 200 free cases = \$0
Food Per Person: \$3 per Person AVG * 200 Total Attendees = \$600
Event Booth & Setup Costs: \$500 per Event X 4 Events = \$2,000
Indirect Costs: 10% of \$7,000 = \$700

YEAR 1 TOTAL COST: \$7,700

Please describe the plan in place to ensure this program remains sustainable

- 1. Diversified Funding Streams:
While the grant from the funding agency will provide an initial boost, we are actively seeking multiple sources of funding, including corporate sponsorships, private donations, and other grant opportunities. This diversified approach ensures a steady flow of resources, reducing over-reliance on a single funding source.
- 2. Community Partnerships:
By forging strong collaborations with local businesses, organizations, and educational institutions like Colorado Mesa University, we can co-host events, share resources, and benefit from mutual promotion. These partnerships not only enhance our program's reach but also provide shared responsibility and investment in its success.
- 3. Revenue-Generating Activities:
We plan to introduce merchandise sales and membership programs. The revenue generated from these activities will be reinvested into the program, ensuring its continuity and growth.

4. Volunteer Engagement:

Our program heavily relies on the dedication of volunteers, from peer support specialists to event organizers. By creating a robust volunteer training and recognition program, we can reduce operational costs while fostering a sense of community ownership and involvement.

What is the program's target population?

1. University Students:

Our primary focus is on the student body of Colorado Mesa University. This includes both undergraduate and graduate students who are seeking a safe, alcohol-free environment to enjoy football games and other related events.

2. Individuals in Recovery:

We aim to support those who are in recovery from substance use disorders, providing them with a space where they can socialize and enjoy events without the triggers or pressures often associated with alcohol or drug use.

3. Families and Friends:

Recognizing the importance of a supportive community, our program welcomes the families and friends of students and those in recovery. This inclusive approach fosters understanding and strengthens the support network for those abstaining from substances.

4. Local Residents:

Beyond the university community, we also cater to residents of Mesa County and surrounding areas who are interested in participating in sober events and supporting the cause.

5. LGBTQ+ Community:

We strive to create an inclusive environment for all, recognizing that members of the LGBTQ+ community may face unique challenges related to substance use and mental health. Our events aim to be safe spaces where everyone feels welcomed and accepted.

6. BIPOC (Black, Indigenous, People of Color) Community:

Recognizing the diverse cultural backgrounds and experiences of the BIPOC community, we ensure our events are culturally sensitive and inclusive, addressing any specific needs or preferences.

7. Non-drinkers and Sober Curious:

Not everyone who attends our events is in recovery. Many individuals choose not to drink for personal, health, or cultural reasons. Our program also caters to the "sober curious" – those who are exploring a reduced or alcohol-free lifestyle.

8. Youth and High School Students:

While our primary focus is on university students, we also aim to engage younger populations, promoting early education about the benefits of sobriety and providing them with positive role models.

9. Community Partners and Advocates:

Local organizations, businesses, and individuals who support harm-reduction, sobriety, and recovery initiatives are also considered part of our target audience. Their involvement amplifies our reach and impact.

Does the program have service limitations? No

What are the parameters for client eligibility?

1. Commitment to a Sober Environment:

All participants must commit to maintaining a sober environment during the events. This means no consumption of alcohol or illicit drugs during the event.

2. Affiliation with Colorado Mesa University:

While the primary focus is on students, faculty, staff, and alumni of Colorado Mesa University, the events are also open to the broader community. However, students and university affiliates may receive priority for certain activities or resources.

3. Respectful Behavior:

Attendees must adhere to a code of conduct that promotes respect, inclusivity, and safety. Any form of harassment, discrimination, or disruptive behavior will not be tolerated.

4. Age Restrictions:

Some events or portions of the tailgate might have age restrictions, especially if they are designed specifically for university students.

5. No Current Alcohol or Drug Intoxication:

To ensure the safety and integrity of the sober environment, individuals who appear to be under the influence of alcohol or drugs may be asked to leave the event.

6. Confidentiality and Privacy:

Participants who engage in peer support or utilize harm-reduction resources must respect the confidentiality and privacy of others. Sharing personal stories or experiences should be done with consent and discretion.

7. Collaboration with Community Partners:

Individuals affiliated with community partners or organizations collaborating with Sober AF Entertainment for the events/tailgates may have specific eligibility criteria or roles during the events.

8. Inclusivity:

While there are parameters for eligibility, it's essential to note that the program aims to be as inclusive as possible. Regardless of race, gender, sexual orientation, socioeconomic status, or recovery status, all who are committed to maintaining a sober and respectful environment are welcome.

Does this program charge clients for services? No

Do other programs in Mesa County provide similar services? No

How does this program address the diverse needs of populations that are specific to your region (LGBTQ+, BIPOC, immigrants, rural communities, low income, etc.)

1. LGBTQ+ Community:

- Inclusivity Training: Our team undergoes training to ensure that our events are LGBTQ+ friendly and inclusive. We strive to create a safe space where everyone feels welcomed and respected.
- Partnerships: We collaborate with LGBTQ+ organizations in the region to ensure our events cater to the specific needs and concerns of this community, such as our partners from Gay & Sober.

2. BIPOC (Black, Indigenous, People of Color):

- Cultural Sensitivity: Recognizing the unique challenges faced by BIPOC communities, especially regarding substance use and recovery, our events incorporate culturally sensitive resources and support.
- Diverse Representation: We ensure that our peer support specialists and event organizers represent diverse backgrounds, providing relatable support to BIPOC attendees.

3. Low Income:

- Free Participation: Our tailgate events are free of charge, ensuring that financial constraints are not a barrier to participation.

- Resource Distribution: We provide attendees with harm-reduction resources, such as naloxone kits, at no cost. Additionally, we connect individuals with affordable or free local recovery and support services.

4. Inclusivity and Representation:

- Community Feedback: We actively seek feedback from diverse community groups to ensure our events are as inclusive as possible.
- Diverse Entertainment: Our events feature diverse entertainment options, including performers and speakers from various backgrounds, to resonate with a broad audience.

5. Collaboration with Community Partners:

- Local Organizations: By partnering with local organizations that cater to specific communities (e.g., LGBTQ+ organizations, BIPOC community groups), we ensure our events are tailored to the unique needs of these populations.
- Shared Resources: Collaborative efforts allow us to pool resources and knowledge, ensuring that our events are both comprehensive and culturally sensitive.

What is the geographic service area for this program? Grand Junction

Program Demographics

		Two year prior FY actual	Most recently completed FY actual	Current FY projected	Next FY projected
1	Clients: Total # of unduplicated clients			200	200
2	Gender: Male				
3	Gender: Female				
4	Gender: Other				
5	Gender: Not Reported			200	200
6	TOTAL FROM ROWS 2-6 (should match total from row 1)			200	200
7	Area: Grand Junction (81501- 81507)			200	

8	Area: Clifton (81520)		
9	Area: Palisade (81526)		
10	Area: Fruita Area (81521, 81524, 81525)		
11	Area: Other Mesa County (Glade Park, Colbran, etc.)		
12	Area: Outside Mesa County		
13	Area: Not Reported		
14	TOTAL FROM ROWS 7-13 (should match total from row 1)	200	200
15	Ethnicity: White		
16	Ethnicity: Hispanic		
17	Ethnicity: Asian- American		
18	Ethnicity: African- American		
19	Ethnicity: Native American		
20	Ethnicity: Other		
21	Ethnicity: Not Reported	200	200

22	TOTAL FROM ROWS 15-21 (should match total from row 1)	200	200
23	Age: 0-4		
24	Age: 5-14		
25	Age: 15-18		
26	Age: 19-34		
27	Age: 35-54		
28	Age: 55-70		
29	Age: 71+		
30	Age: Not Reported	200	200
31	TOTAL FROM ROWS 23-30 (should match total from row 1)	200	200

Current Program Staffing

	Number of full-time staff	Number of part-time/seasonal staff	Number of volunteers
1	1	1	40

Please use this space if there is additional information regarding the applying agency or program that is vital to convey in this application

Our media & press strategy has become way more ironed out and effective and would love for your team to check out the the speaker & promo videos we have accumulated:
https://www.youtube.com/channel/UCK_vIWQtYkuW-45fkj5EQA

Discuss the resources, tools, and staffing available that will be utilized to reach program outcomes during the funding cycle

1. Resources:

- Harm-Reduction Kits: We have secured a stockpile of harm-reduction kits, including naloxone, to distribute during our events. These kits are essential in providing immediate assistance in the event of an overdose.
- Educational Materials: Comprehensive literature on substance abuse prevention, the benefits of sobriety, and local support resources will be available for attendees.
- Promotional Materials: To maximize outreach and attendance, we have designed promotional materials such as flyers, banners, and digital ads tailored for various platforms.

2. Tools:

- Digital Platforms: Our organization utilizes a robust digital infrastructure, including a website and mobile app, to provide information, accept registrations, and offer virtual support.
- Feedback Mechanisms: We employ digital surveys and feedback forms to gather attendee insights, helping us refine and improve subsequent events.
- Data Analytics: Advanced data analytics tools help us monitor event attendance, engagement levels, and the effectiveness of our outreach campaigns.

3. Staffing:

- Peer Support Specialists: Trained individuals, many of whom have lived experience with substance abuse, will be present to offer support, share their stories, and guide attendees towards relevant resources.
- Event Organizers: A dedicated team is responsible for the logistical aspects of the event, ensuring smooth operations from setup to teardown.
- Community Liaisons: These individuals foster relationships with local organizations, community leaders, and other stakeholders to enhance the program's reach and effectiveness.

4. Collaborative Partnerships:

- Local Community Organizations: We have established partnerships with local organizations that cater to specific demographics, ensuring our events are culturally sensitive and relevant.
- Educational Institutions: Our partnership with Colorado Mesa University and other educational entities ensures we can effectively target the student population, a crucial demographic for our program.

Provide a narrative of the actions the program will take to reach the desired outcomes during the funding cycle, utilizing the resources listed above

1. Pre-Event Planning and Outreach:

- Community Engagement: Our community liaisons will engage with local organizations, especially those serving specific demographics like LGBTQ+, BIPOC, and immigrants. These partnerships aim to ensure our events are inclusive and cater to the diverse needs of the Mesa County community.
- Logistical Preparations: The event organizers will secure the necessary permits, coordinate with Colorado Mesa University for venue arrangements, and ensure all required resources, from harm-reduction kits to educational materials, are in place.

2. During the Event:

- Peer Support: Our trained peer support specialists will be strategically positioned throughout the event. They will engage with attendees, share their personal stories, offer immediate support, and guide individuals to relevant resources.
- Distribution of Harm-Reduction Kits: Designated stalls will be set up to distribute naloxone and other harm-reduction materials. Attendees will also receive training on how to use these kits effectively.
- Feedback Collection: Digital kiosks and mobile tablets will be available for attendees to provide real-time feedback on the event, allowing us to make immediate adjustments if necessary.

3. Post-Event Actions:

- Data Analysis: Our evaluation and monitoring team will analyze the data collected, from attendance numbers to feedback forms, to assess the event's impact and areas of improvement.
- Community Follow-Up: Post-event surveys will be sent out to attendees to gather more detailed feedback. Our community liaisons will also engage with partner organizations to understand their perspectives on the event's success.
- Refinement for Future Events: Based on the insights gathered, our team will identify areas of improvement and implement changes for subsequent tailgates.
- Promotion of Continuous Support: Beyond the event, attendees will be encouraged to engage with our digital platforms for continuous support, resources, and updates on future events.
- Resource Updates: As the opioid crisis evolves, we will ensure our resources, especially educational materials and harm-reduction kits, remain updated and relevant.

Describe the audience served, number of clients that will receive assistance during the funding cycle, and what services will be offered to each

Breakdown of Audience:

- College Students: This group forms the bulk of our audience. They are at a critical juncture in their lives, often exposed to peer pressures related to substance use. Our program aims to provide them with a safe, substance-free environment to enjoy events and access resources.
- Local Community Members: Residents of Mesa County, especially those affected by the opioid crisis either directly or indirectly, are a significant part of our audience. They benefit from the resources, support, and community engagement our events offer.

Number of Clients and Services Offered:

- During the funding cycle, we anticipate serving approximately 200 attendees across the four events. Here's a breakdown of the services each attendee can access:
 1. Peer Support: Every attendee has the opportunity to engage with trained peer support specialists, offering immediate emotional support, guidance, and personal stories of recovery.
 2. Harm-Reduction Kits: We aim to distribute around 200 naloxone kits during the funding cycle. Along with the kits, attendees receive training on their effective use.
 3. Educational Resources: All attendees can access educational materials on substance use, prevention, and recovery. These resources aim to raise awareness and provide actionable steps for those seeking help.
 4. Feedback and Continuous Support: Attendees can provide real-time feedback during the event and are encouraged to engage with our digital platforms post-event for continuous support and resources.

Provide a final desired outcome statement

Through the Sober AF Entertainment Football Tailgates Program at Colorado Mesa University, we aim to foster a supportive, substance-free community environment that not only offers an alternative to traditional event experiences but also equips attendees with the resources, knowledge, and skills to combat the opioid crisis. By the end of the funding cycle, we aspire to see a measurable reduction in substance-related incidents within the university community, an increase in awareness about substance use prevention, and a strengthened network of peer support. Our ultimate goal is to empower 200+ individuals to make informed choices, promote health equity, and create a ripple effect of positive change throughout Mesa County.

Describe your program's overall approach to evaluation. Refer to methods, instruments, and procedures (surveys, interviews, tests, logs, etc.) for collecting data, and your process for analyzing the data.

1. Surveys: Event surveys will be distributed to all attendees to gather feedback on their experience, the perceived impact of the event, and suggestions for improvement. These surveys will be both quantitative (Likert scale questions) and qualitative (open-ended questions).
2. Logs: Attendance logs will track the number of participants at each tailgate, and resource distribution logs will monitor the number of naloxone kits distributed and training sessions attended.

What are the instruments or tools you will use to measure change?

- 1. Participant Surveys: Customized questionnaires will be developed to gauge participants' experiences, knowledge gain, and behavioral intentions post-event. These surveys will include questions for quantitative analysis and open-ended questions for qualitative insights.
- 2. Attendance Logs: These logs will track the number of participants at each event, allowing us to measure reach and engagement over time.
- 3. Resource Distribution Logs: We will maintain records of the number of harm-reduction resources and naloxone kits distributed during each event. This will help quantify our direct impact in terms of resources provided to the community.
- 4. Feedback Forms: These forms will be available at each event for participants to provide immediate feedback on sessions, resources, and overall event experience.
- 5. Community Partner Feedback Forms: Collaborative partners and local community organizations involved in the program will be provided with feedback forms to share their observations, insights, and suggestions for program enhancement.

How will evaluation results be used?

- 1. Program Improvement: The primary use of evaluation results will be to identify areas of strength and areas needing improvement within the program. Feedback on sessions, resources, and overall event experiences will guide refinements to ensure maximum effectiveness and participant satisfaction.
- 2. Stakeholder Communication: Evaluation results will be shared with stakeholders, including funders, community partners, and participants. Transparent communication of outcomes reinforces trust and showcases the program's impact and areas of growth.
- 3. Resource Allocation: Insights from the evaluation will inform decisions on where to allocate resources more effectively, ensuring that areas with the most significant needs or potential for impact receive adequate attention and support.
- 4. Scaling and Expansion: Positive evaluation results can be leveraged to seek additional funding or partnerships, allowing the program to expand its reach and serve a broader audience.
- 5. Training and Development: Feedback on the performance of peer support specialists and other staff members will guide training initiatives, ensuring that our team is equipped with the skills and knowledge to excel in their roles.
- 6. Advocacy and Policy Influence: Demonstrable success, backed by robust evaluation data, can be used to advocate for policies that support harm-reduction initiatives and peer-driven sober support models at a broader level.
- 7. Knowledge Sharing: Evaluation results can be shared with other organizations or entities looking to implement similar programs, contributing to a knowledge base and promoting best practices in the field.

Quantity of clients served and outcome data

		Most recently completed FY actual	Current FY projected	Next FY projected	Following FY Projected (Year 2)
1	Total # of clients served	0		200	200

2	# of clients utilizing youth mentoring opportunities	0		0
3	# of clients utilizing youth diversion program	0		0
4	# of clients receiving prevention education	0	200	200
5	# of CAS trainings offered	0		0
6	# of clients receiving SUD treatment and wrap around services	0		0
7	# of clients receiving peer delivered care coordination	0	100	100
8	# of peer recovery specialist trainings provided	0	20	20

Please upload the following documents:

1. Current agency operating budget
2. Current program budget
3. Copy of your most recent audited financial statements, compilation, or review
4. Most recent 990 or other tax filing
5. Colorado Secretary of State Certificate of Good Standing or Certificate of Registration (if applicable)
6. Licensures and designations with the Office of Behavioral Health and/or the Colorado Department of Public Health and Environment if applicable to your agency/program

Current agency operating budget



PDF	12-2022 Financials SoberA... (70 KiB download)
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Current program budget

PDF	MESA COUNTY GRANT - SAFE... (75 KiB download)
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Copy of your most recent audited financial statements, compilation, or review

PDF	7-2023 Financials -SoberA... (95 KiB download)
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Most recent 990 or other tax filing

PDF	2022 990 Return - Sober A... (344 KiB download)
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Colorado Secretary of State Certificate of Good Standing and Certificate of Registration (if applicable)

PDF	3 Colorado Secretary of S... (477 KiB download)
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Log in to uwmesacountygrants.grantplatform.com to see complete application attachments.